04-29 第1篇

阅读理解（说明文） From Leaf to Cup: How Chinese Green Tea Is Made

① Every spring, millions of Chinese families welcome the new year's tea. A fresh cup of **green tea** is clear, light green, and smells of young grass and sweet nuts. But few teenagers know that a single cup of good green tea may take **six careful steps** to make, and that some top teas, like **Longjing (Dragon Well)** in Hangzhou, have been made in almost the same way for more than **a thousand years**.

② **Step 1: Picking.** In early April, when the new leaves on the tea bush are the size of a bird's tongue, skilled workers — often women with quick fingers — pick **only the top bud and one or two young leaves** from each branch. One kilogram of top green tea may need over **30,000** such tiny shoots. All picking must happen before the heat of the day; otherwise the leaves lose their freshness.

③ **Step 2: Spreading.** Back at the tea house, the leaves are laid out on **large bamboo trays** in a cool, shaded room. Here they rest for 4—6 hours. During this quiet time, a little water in the leaves evaporates, and some sharp grass smell fades. The leaves become soft and ready for the next step.

④ **Step 3: Killing the green.** This is the most important step, and also the one with the most poetic name — **shā qīng (杀青)**. The leaves are quickly heated in a large iron pan at about **200 °C**. The high heat stops the natural **enzymes** inside the leaves from turning them brown. This is why green tea stays green, while black tea is allowed to brown fully. A good tea master uses both hands and feels the leaves like a cook feels a child's forehead.

⑤ **Step 4: Shaping.** While still warm, the leaves are pressed flat in the pan, hand after hand. Longjing tea gets its famous **flat, sword-like shape** in this step. Other teas, like **Biluochun** in Jiangsu, are rolled into small green curls. Each shape is not only beautiful; it also helps the tea **release flavour slowly** when hot water meets it in your cup.

⑥ **Step 5: Drying.** The tea is then dried in baskets over low heat until it **breaks easily** between two fingers. Good green tea must not be damp, or it will grow mould in the package. At this stage, the colour becomes that famous **warm, soft green** which seems almost gold under lamplight.

⑦ **Step 6: Sorting and packing.** Workers remove any broken leaves or tiny stems, and put the finished tea into **sealed bags** with small packets that keep out water. Some top teas also go into cold rooms for a week to "rest". From the first picking to the final bag, the whole process can take **10 to 14 days**.

⑧ When you next hold a small cup of new green tea, remember those six steps, the thousand springs behind them, and the skilled hands of the pickers and tea masters. A single cup may look simple, but it is a quiet gift from mountains, weather, time, and people all working together.

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. How old is the traditional way of making top Chinese green teas like Longjing?

A. About 50 years.
B. About 100 years.
C. More than a thousand years.
D. Only 10 years.

2. How many tea shoots may be needed for one kilogram of top green tea?

A. About 300.
B. About 3,000.
C. More than 30,000.
D. More than 3 million.

3. What happens in the step of "killing the green" (shā qīng)?

A. The leaves are dipped in sugar water.
B. The leaves are heated quickly to stop the enzymes and keep the green colour.
C. The leaves are frozen into ice.
D. The leaves are dried in the sun for one week.

4. Which of these shapes is famous for Longjing tea?

A. Small green curls.
B. Flat, sword-like leaves.
C. Large round balls.
D. Hollow paper cups.

5. Why must the final tea be very dry before packing?

A. Because dry tea looks richer in the shop.
B. Because wet tea can grow mould in the package.
C. Because dry tea is heavier.
D. Because wet tea is illegal.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段 "more than a thousand years"
【解析】制作方式已有千余年。故选 C。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "over 30,000"
【解析】约三万多个嫩芽。故选 C。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "stops the natural enzymes"
【解析】高温停止酶使茶保绿。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段 "flat, sword-like shape"
【解析】扁平剑形。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段 "damp... grow mould"
【解析】潮湿会发霉。故选 B。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **enzyme** [n.] 酶
- **bud** [n.] 嫩芽/花蕾
- **mould** [n.] 霉菌